

Ellan Vannin Wealth Management

Sovereign Infrastructure Investment Memorandum

The Cardiff Atlantic Gateway Port Programme

A Public–Private Partnership to Create Wales' Global Maritime Economy

Executive Summary

Ellan Vannin Wealth Management (EVWM) proposes the creation of:

The Cardiff Atlantic Gateway Investment Partnership (CAGIP)

A long-term infrastructure investment vehicle to transform Cardiff's maritime assets into a modern Atlantic-facing economic platform.

The objective:

Re-establish Cardiff as a major Atlantic trading city by combining port infrastructure, renewable energy, logistics, manufacturing and waterfront regeneration.

Cardiff has historically been one of Britain's great maritime cities. Its docks powered the global coal trade of the 19th and early 20th centuries. The Cardiff Bay regeneration programme later demonstrated the economic potential of transforming former dockland, creating thousands of jobs and large-scale mixed-use development.

The next stage is to move from:

Regenerated waterfront

to:

Productive Atlantic Port City

Investment Thesis

The Problem

South Wales has:

- industrial capability
- universities
- energy expertise
- manufacturing skills
- Atlantic location

but lacks a world-scale maritime growth engine.

Major UK ports are concentrated around:

- Southampton
- Felixstowe
- London Gateway
- Liverpool

Cardiff should become:

Britain's Western Industrial Gateway

Strategic Vision

Cardiff Atlantic Port

A combined:

- commercial port
- energy hub
- logistics centre
- industrial park
- maritime technology cluster
- cruise and tourism gateway

Comparable models:

- Rotterdam
 - Hamburg
 - Bilbao
 - Singapore
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Investment Structure

Cardiff Atlantic Gateway Fund

Total Programme:

£2 billion

25-year investment horizon.

Capital structure:

Source	Investment
EVWM	£400m
Pension funds	£800m
Private infrastructure investors	£500m
Government partnership	£300m

Pillar One

Cardiff Deep Water Port Expansion

Investment:

£600 million

Objective

Create a modern Atlantic freight gateway.

Potential locations:

- Cardiff Docks
 - Queen Alexandra Dock
 - Roath Basin
 - wider Severn Estuary industrial zones
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Infrastructure:

- upgraded quays

- container handling
 - bulk cargo facilities
 - automated logistics systems
 - customs facilities
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Target Markets

Imports

- construction materials
 - food products
 - manufactured goods
 - energy products
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Exports

- Welsh manufacturing
 - advanced materials
 - engineering products
 - renewable energy equipment
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Economic Benefit

A Cardiff port expansion reduces dependency on English ports and creates a western logistics corridor.

Pillar Two

Celtic Sea Renewable Energy Hub

Investment:

£500 million

The Celtic Sea offshore wind opportunity creates a major industrial opportunity for Welsh ports.

Cardiff becomes:

The Renewable Energy Port of South Wales

Facilities:

- offshore wind assembly
 - maintenance base
 - subsea engineering
 - cable manufacture
 - marine services
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Associated industries:

- hydrogen
 - tidal power
 - battery systems
 - electrical engineering
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Employment Impact

Potential:

5,000–10,000 specialist jobs over time.

Pillar Three

Cardiff Maritime Manufacturing Zone

Investment:

£350 million

Create:

Cardiff Industrial Waterfront

Redevelop underused dockland into:

- factories
- warehouses

- engineering workshops
 - technology businesses
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Target sectors:

- marine engineering
 - robotics
 - defence manufacturing
 - advanced materials
 - clean technology
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The concept:

Not just moving goods.

Making goods.

Pillar Four

Port Rail Renaissance

Investment:

£250 million

A port is only valuable if connected.

Upgrade:

- freight rail links
 - intermodal terminals
 - logistics yards
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Create:

Atlantic Freight Corridor

Connecting:

Cardiff

↓

Newport

↓

Bristol

↓

Midlands

↓

Northern England

Benefits:

- lower logistics costs
 - fewer road miles
 - stronger supply chains
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Pillar Five

Cardiff Waterfront Economic District

Investment:

£300 million

Existing Cardiff Bay regeneration created a major transformation of former dockland, including housing, leisure, commercial development and public spaces.

The next phase:

Move from consumption waterfront:

- restaurants
- apartments
- leisure

towards:

Productive waterfront.

Create:

- maritime headquarters

- research centres
 - hotels
 - conference facilities
 - marine innovation campuses
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This builds on existing Atlantic Wharf regeneration plans, which already envision large mixed-use development around Cardiff Bay.

Pillar Six

Atlantic Passenger Economy

Investment:

£100 million

Cardiff becomes a gateway for:

- cruise tourism
 - Irish Sea routes
 - Atlantic travel
 - marine leisure
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Potential services:

- Cardiff–Ireland ferry revival
 - coastal tourism
 - maritime events
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Economic Model

Total Investment

£2 billion

Construction Impact

Estimated:

15,000–20,000 job-years

Permanent Employment

Sector	Jobs
Port operations	2,000
Energy	5,000
Manufacturing	5,000
Logistics	3,000
Services	3,000

Potential:

15,000–20,000 jobs

GDP Impact

The fund creates economic value through:

- trade
 - industrial clustering
 - energy investment
 - productivity improvements
 - land value uplift
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Conservative Scenario

Annual regional GVA increase:

£750 million

Growth Scenario

With renewable energy and manufacturing clusters:

£1.5 billion+ annual GVA

Revenue Model

The fund generates returns from:

Port Operations

- handling charges
 - leases
 - storage
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Industrial Property

- factories
 - warehouses
 - offices
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Energy Infrastructure

- offshore wind services
 - hydrogen infrastructure
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Logistics

- freight terminals
 - distribution centres
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Investment Returns

Target:

7–10% long-term infrastructure return

Strategic Relationship With Wider EVWM Portfolio

The Cardiff Atlantic Gateway connects with:

Energy

- tidal power
- LNG flexibility
- offshore wind

Transport

- South Wales rail upgrades
- Bristol connection
- Atlantic logistics

Urban Development

- Cardiff Bay regeneration

Tourism

- Wales coastal economy
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Strategic Comparison

City	Economic Role
London	Finance
Manchester	Digital/services
Birmingham	National industrial hub
Liverpool	Irish Sea gateway
Cardiff	Atlantic gateway

Final Recommendation

Ellan Vannin Wealth Management should establish:

The Cardiff Atlantic Gateway Investment Partnership

A sovereign-style PPP designed to restore Cardiff's historic maritime role.

The ambition:

Not simply to expand a port.

But to create:

Wales' Atlantic Economic Engine.

The strategic logic:

Ports create trade.

Trade creates industry.

Industry creates skills.

Skills create long-term prosperity.

Cardiff has the history, location and industrial foundations to become Britain's western-facing gateway economy once again.